

waits five seconds for an application to respond before deciding that it's hung and asking you to manually end it.

Navigate to the same key:

HCU\Control Panel\Desktop

Change the HungAppTimeout String Value from the default 5000 to, say, 2000, or even 1000. Be careful, though. If you have a program that runs slowly, XP, with this new value, could wrongly determine that a task has hung. If that seems to happen, increase the HungAppTimeout value in increments until false alarms stop.

The Most-Hated Balloon Of Them All

Why the incessant balloon warnings when you run low on disk space? It's not like these balloons help anyway—they offer to clear a few KB, and if you're lucky a couple of MB—of space by deleting temp files, clearing the Recycle Bin and such, depending on your settings. (As if you couldn't think of deleting files yourself!) Here's the warning we're talking about:

"You are running out of disk space on [drive]. To free space on this drive by deleting old or unnecessary files, click here."

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer

Create or modify the DWORD called NoLowDiskSpaceChecks. Make it 1 to disable the alerts, and if you miss them, make the value 0 to have them return in all their glory.

Die!

This doesn't happen often, but when it does, it can be a major irritant—especially if you like your Windows all nice and neat. Some programs don't vanish from the Add/Remove Programs list even after you delete them. You can manually remove these from the list.